

Equity Compensation Checklist for Executives

A self-guided checklist for executives navigating stock options, RSUs, and deferred compensation.

Equity compensation can be a meaningful part of an executive's overall financial picture, but it comes with its own timing, tax, and concentration-risk considerations that don't apply to salary alone. This checklist is designed to help you identify areas that may be worth a closer look, whether you're newly granted equity or sitting on a build-up of vested shares. It's a starting point for reflection, not a substitute for an individualized conversation.

Understanding Your Grants

Do you know the vesting schedule for each type of equity compensation you hold (RSUs, stock options, ESPP, and similar)?

Have you reviewed the tax treatment for each type of equity award you have?

Do you know your company's blackout periods and trading policies?

Tax & Timing

Have you thought through the cash-flow and tax implications of exercising stock options, if you hold them?

Have you talked with a tax professional about the timing of equity-related income?

Have you considered whether a deferred-compensation election, if available to you, fits your broader plan?

Risk & Diversification

Have you calculated what percentage of your net worth is concentrated in company stock?

Have you considered a diversification approach for vested shares?

Have you reviewed whether a 10b5-1 trading plan might be appropriate for your situation?

Have you thought through how a job change or departure would affect unvested equity?

Have you coordinated equity-compensation decisions with your broader financial plan?

Next step: if several of these items raise questions for you, an introductory conversation may help.
Reach out any time — there's no cost or obligation to talk.

This checklist is educational and informational only. It is not individualized investment, tax, or legal advice, is not a complete financial plan, and should not be relied on as the sole basis for any financial decision. Items on this checklist may not apply to every situation. [COMPLIANCE REVIEW REQUIRED]

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